

write a very simple program, with the least operations necessary, to understand the steps listed above. Almost all programs that you write using Xlib will have pretty much the same basic steps, with additional code providing application-specific functionality.

The program

Our simple program opens a window with a black background, and closes it after a short delay. The code is as follows:

```
#include <X11/Xlib.h> /*Xlib header
file*/
#include <stdio.h>

int main(void)
{
    Display dis; /*Variable for handling
display*/
    Window win; /*Variable for handling
window*/
    dis = XOpenDisplay(NULL);
```

```
/*We have just opened a connection with
the X server.
```

```
    If this fails, the function will
    return a '0' */
    win = XCreateSimpleWindow(dis,
RootWindow(dis, 0), 1, 1, 500, 500, 0,
BlackPixel (dis, 0), BlackPixel (dis,
0));
    /*This function will create a simple
window of 500x500 with black background*/
    XMapWindow(dis, win);
    /*The XMapWindow function maps the
window and all
    of its subwindows that have had map
requests. */
    XFlush(dis); /*The XFlush function
flushes the output buffer.*/
    sleep(5); /*Freeze for 5 seconds before
closing.*/
    XCloseDisplay(dis); /*Close the
```

```
connection with the X server */
    return(0);
}
```

Compile the program with: `gcc ip.c -o op -lX11` and run it with: `./op`

Conclusion

These are the steps necessary to write a program with Xlib. 'C' programmers ought not to face any difficulty in understanding the program, since most parts are self-explanatory. We will do a program to plot graph points in my next article, but I would like you to explore some part of Xlib on your own; I suggest you take a look at the graphics functions, like drawing a rectangle. Obtaining some insight before the next article would definitely help you understand the scope of Xlib. 

By: Amol Takkalki

The author has been using Linux for the past three years, and is a big fan of it. His hobbies are photography and programming. You can contact him at takkalki.amol@gmail.com.

support@
efyindia.com

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